

## SKITTLE & THE FLYING TEST:

In a lush green swamp, there lived a family of tiny, Winged Dragons. The youngest dragon was named Skittle, and he was just old enough to start flying. Flying is very hard because there are so many hazards. Fish can jump up out of the water and catch you. You can get tangled up in the ferns or lost in the mist. Frogs can catch you with their long sticky tongues. Because of all these things, each winged dragon had to learn from the Dragonfly Master, and then pass a flying test before he could zip and dart freely about the swamp. Skittle was excited about his flying lessons. He knew how important it was that he train hard and practice his moves each day. He set goals for himself and worked to meet them. The Dragonfly Master praised him for his great attitude, and his hard work. On the day of the big test, the Dragonfly Master set up an obstacle course for the young winged dragons to speed through. They had to fly their fastest, make tight turns, avoid branches and leaves, and land safely on a cattail reed. Everyone felt ready and confident. At the far end of the swamp, a hungry frog was watching the class. He quickly jumped to the cattail reed and hid down in the mud, his tongue ready to grab the first dragonfly to reach the finish. Luckily, Skittle was the first winged dragon to test. He flew his fastest and zoomed just above the water. He maneuvered around the ferns, over the rocks and between the bushes. He was just about to land when he spotted the hungry frog. He twisted around quickly as the frog lunged at him. All the other winged dragon watched in horror as the frog tried to eat Skittle. Because Skittle had learned so many flying tricks from the Dragonfly Master, he was able to twirl and spin and make the frog dizzy. The frog fell with a loud splash back into the swamp where a hungry fish was waiting to gobble him up! All the winged dragons cheered for Skittle! When we start something new, it is important to have a great attitude. We must set goals, be confident, and work hard